

Thursday, 2 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

25° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

21° 16°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

19° 14°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

17° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 Households across the UK are being urged to read their energy meters today as new, higher prices kick in.

The energy regulator Ofgem has announced a 13% annual rise in household energy prices, with the latest price cap now in effect. Submitting a meter reading ensures you're billed accurately before the new rates apply.

COST OF LIVING · UK

2 Teachers in England are set to receive a 3.5% pay rise, but unions warn it could stretch school budgets even further.

Schools will need to fund some of the increase themselves, leading to concerns about the financial pressures on already tight budgets. This comes as the cost of living continues to impact many households.

EDUCATION · UK

3 A new investigation has found major retailers are still advertising e-scooters for commuting, despite them being banned on UK roads.

The Press Association investigation discovered e-scooters being promoted for 'commuting' and 'urban riding'. This highlights a disconnect between advertising and the current legal restrictions on their use.

TRANSPORT · UK

4 Up to 150 former WHSmith High Street stores are set to close as a rescue deal for the retailer has been approved.

A court has sanctioned a sweeping restructuring, which will also see steep rent cuts on most of the remaining stores. This marks a significant change for a familiar name on British high streets.

BUSINESS · UK

5 The Conservative leader Kemi Badenoch has accused Labour's Andy Burnham of inheriting a 'mess' in defence spending.

Ms Badenoch criticised what she called a missing five billion pounds in the government's defence investment plan. This political debate centres on the financial future of the UK's defence capabilities.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 A famous West End theatre in London is being renamed in honour of the celebrated playwright Sir Tom Stoppard.**
The Duke of York's Theatre will soon bear the name of the acclaimed writer. This is a significant tribute to one of Britain's most influential theatrical figures.
ON AIR – What's your favourite play by Sir Tom Stoppard?
THEATRE · COMING UP
- 2 Canada is set to make its debut in the Eurovision Song Contest in 2027, becoming the first new participant in years.**
This marks a major expansion for the popular international music competition. Canada will be the first new country to join since Australia entered the contest back in 2015.
ON AIR – Do you think Canada will bring a new flavour to Eurovision, or will it be business as usual?
MUSIC · 2027
- 3 Speculation is mounting about Taylor Swift's rumoured wedding celebrations in New York City.**
While the couple has remained quiet, reports suggest a multi-day celebration at Madison Square Garden could be on the cards. Fans are eagerly awaiting any official news.
ON AIR – If you were planning a celebrity wedding, what unusual venue would you pick?
CELEBRITY · COMING UP
- 4 Rare David Bowie items are set to begin a V&A exhibition tour, starting in Dundee later this year.**
The show, which opens in November, will feature stage costumes, musical instruments, and drawings from the iconic artist. It's a chance for fans to get up close with Bowie's legacy.
ON AIR – What's your all-time favourite David Bowie song?
EXHIBITION · NOVEMBER
- 5 Tens of thousands of people have rushed for tickets to see the historic Bayeux Tapestry on its first ever visit to the UK.**
The ancient masterpiece will travel from France to be displayed on British soil for the very first time. It's a truly once-in-a-lifetime opportunity for many.
ON AIR – If you could see any historical artefact up close, what would it be?
EXHIBITION · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 Nottingham Forest are reportedly set to replace manager Vitor Pereira with former Crystal Palace boss Oliver Glasner.**

Pereira is poised to leave the club, paving the way for Glasner to take over. This signals a significant change in leadership for Forest.

ON AIR – Do you think Oliver Glasner is the right man to lead Nottingham Forest?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Serena Williams' hopes of playing doubles with her sister Venus at Wimbledon are in doubt due to a knee injury.**

The injury could impact the highly anticipated pairing of the legendary sisters on the grass courts. Fans will be hoping for a swift recovery.

ON AIR – How much do you think Serena and Venus still have to offer on the tennis court?

TENNIS · UK
- 3 Hull City avoided a potential points deduction in the Premier League by selling two players just hours before the deadline.**

The club managed to secure the sales on Tuesday, narrowly escaping a penalty. It was a dramatic dash to meet the financial fair play requirements.

ON AIR – Is it fair that clubs have to sell players to avoid points deductions?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 British tennis player Dan Evans has bid an emotional farewell to his career at Wimbledon.**

Evans and his partner Henry Searle lost in the final match of his career, marking the end of an era for the Briton. He received a warm send-off from the crowd.

ON AIR – What's your favourite memory of Dan Evans' career?

TENNIS · UK
- 5 Chelsea have completed the signing of Italy defender Marco Palestra for a reported £47 million.**

The 21-year-old right-back becomes Xabi Alonso's first signing as Chelsea manager. This is a significant investment as Alonso begins to shape his squad.

ON AIR – Do you think £47 million is a good price for Marco Palestra?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Reusable coffee cups are finally outnumbering disposables in some city centres.**
Cafés offering a small discount have seen the biggest shift. The catch: most of us still leave the cup at home half the time.
- 2 More people are switching their morning scroll for a morning walk, apps suggest.**
Step-counters report a small but steady rise in early-morning activity. The motivation for most? A dog that refuses to wait.
- 3 Board game cafés are booming on UK high streets.**
Owners say the biggest sellers are the quick, daft games — not the four-hour epics. The most common cause of fallouts remains the rules of a certain word game.
- 4 The crossword and puzzle boom is still going strong, in print and on phones.**
Publishers report a surge in daily puzzlers. The most argued-over answer in households remains anything involving a cryptic clue.
- 5 Community 'little libraries' — swap-a-book boxes on the street — are popping up in more neighbourhoods.**
The unwritten rule is take one, leave one. The most-swapped genre, organisers say, is the holiday thriller.
- 6 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.
- 7 A study says the average person walks past their phone over 50 times a day without picking it up.**
Researchers reckon just seeing it nearby is enough reassurance. The phone, meanwhile, remains entirely unbothered.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Nearly 6 in 10 of us have a 'special' version of THIS we won't let anyone else use.

ANSWER: A FAVOURITE MUG.

Q Asked what instantly makes a hotel feel posh, the top answer wasn't the pool — it was THIS.

ANSWER: A LITTLE TRAY OF FREE BISCUITS.

TALK TOPIC

- **If you won the lottery tonight, what's the FIRST thing you'd buy tomorrow?**

Talk-back: not the dream house. Not the holiday. The first daft thing you'd buy because you finally could.

- **What's the worst job you've ever had — and how long did you last?**

Talk-back: the war stories are usually the funniest. Bonus marks for under a fortnight.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Food.** The UK's bestselling biscuit in 2025 wasn't the Custard Cream or the Hobnob — it was the humble digestive, selling over 70 million packs.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Bristol bakery has started selling 'controversial' jam doughnuts injected with mustard instead of jam, claiming a 'small but loyal' customer base.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£69 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£69 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The phrase 'raining cats and dogs' has uncertain origins, but it's been used in English for centuries.
- Wombats, koalas and kangaroos all carry their young in pouches — they're marsupials.
- A 'moment' was once an actual medieval unit of time, lasting about 90 seconds.
- The Statue of Liberty's full height to the torch is over 90 metres including the base.
- Owls can rotate their heads around 270 degrees.
- Carrots were originally purple before orange ones were cultivated.
- The fastest land animal, the cheetah, can go from standstill to motorway speeds in a few seconds.
- There's a species of jellyfish considered biologically 'immortal', able to revert to an earlier life stage.

On this day

Day 183 of the year, 182 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aberoh and Atom (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Bernardino Realino; Christian feast day: Blessed Eugénie Joubert; Christian feast day: Feast of the Visitation (Anglicanism; Levoča at Mariánska hora). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1920 — John Kneubuhl, Samoan-American historian, screenwriter, and playwright (died 1992)
- 1969 — Tim Rodber, English rugby player
- 1993 — Vince Staples, American rapper and actor
- 1956 — Jerry Hall, American model and actress
- 1947 — Larry David, American actor, comedian, producer, and screenwriter
- 1937 — Polly Holliday, American actress (died 2025)
- 1934 — Tom Springfield, English musician (died 2022)
- 1949 — Greg Brown, American musician

THE DAY TODAY

- 2024 — A stampede during a religious event in Uttar Pradesh, India, leaves at least 121 people dead and 150 others injured.
- 1986 — Aeroflot Flight 2306 crashes while attempting an emergency landing at Syktyvkar Airport in Syktyvkar, in present-day Komi Republic, Russia, killing 54 people.
- 1890 — The U.S. Congress passes the Sherman Antitrust Act.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1990 — In the 1990 Mecca tunnel tragedy, 1,400 Muslim pilgrims are suffocated to death and trampled upon in a pedestrian tunnel leading to the holy city of Mecca.
- 1986 — Aeroflot Flight 2306 crashes while attempting an emergency landing at Syktyvkar Airport in Syktyvkar, in present-day Komi Republic, Russia, killing 54 people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1494 — Age of Discovery: The Treaty of Tordesillas is ratified by Spain.
- 1582 — Battle of Yamazaki: Toyotomi Hideyoshi defeats Akechi Mitsuhide.

- 1921 — World War I: U.S. President Warren G. Harding signs the Knox–Porter Resolution formally ending the war between the United States and Germany.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 184 of the year, 181 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anatolius of Constantinople; Christian feast day: Anatolius of Laodicea; Christian feast day: Dathus; Christian feast day: Germanus of Man. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Gary Waldhorn, British actor (died 2022)
- 1952 — Laura Branigan, American singer-songwriter (died 2004)
- 1943 — Kurtwood Smith, American actor
- 1958 — Siân Lloyd, Welsh meteorologist and journalist
- 1973 — Patrick Wilson, American actor
- 1946 — Johnny Lee, American singer and guitarist
- 1930 — Tommy Tedesco, American guitarist (died 1997)
- 1970 — Audra McDonald, American actress and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1967 — The Aden Emergency: The Battle of the Crater in which the British Argyll and Sutherland Highlanders retake the Crater district following the Arab Police mutiny.
- 1884 — Dow Jones & Company publishes its first stock average.
- 1938 — World speed record for a steam locomotive is set in England, by the Mallard, which reaches a speed of 125.88 miles per hour (202.58 km/h).

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The SS United States sets sail on her maiden voyage to Southampton. During the voyage, the ship takes the Blue Riband away from the RMS Queen Mary.
- 1863 — American Civil War: The final day of the Battle of Gettysburg culminates with Pickett's Charge.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)